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Top Skills

Program Management
Quality Assurance
Customer Segmentation Strategy

Patrick Byrne

I help founders get their tech downrange in months, not years.
Seattle, Washington, United States

Summary

Most defense tech founders don’t fail because their tech doesn’t work.
They fail because it never gets downrange.

You can build a world-changing solution, spend years chasing programs of record, and still stall out—drowned in bureaucracy, misaligned execution, or the illusion of progress.

I hear it in every market research call:
* They’re mission-driven, but misaligned.
* They chase contracts, but outsource relationships.
* They mistake motion for progress.
* They delay execution and compliance until it’s too late.
* They don’t need more advice—they need a compass.

I help dual-use and defense tech founders avoid the BD Theater and Bureaucracy Swamp to focus on execution and turn potential into fielded capability.

I’m Patrick Byrne.
I’ve led product, program, and GTM efforts across every layer of defense innovation—from managing the transition of Air Force One, to building AI mission software at Rebellion Defense, to launching dual-use cybersecurity products from the ground up at Hunted Labs.
I’ve managed more than 55 products and driven over $2.1 billion in revenue by leading with Vision, Alignment, and Empowerment.
I’ve deployed technology in some of the most complex, high-stakes environments on Earth. Now I help other leaders do the same.

My practice exists to help founders:
* Find mission-aligned champions who believe in your tech
* Translate pipeline into delivery plans engineers can actually build
* Craft sales promises product can actually keep
* Prepare your team for post-award execution

* Build a culture of internal ownership—not just external BD

My approach is simple and execution-focused:
* 6-Week Founder Bootcamp to transform your vision into a deployable roadmap that’s:
* Clarity-forged — Aligns strategy with execution rhythms
* Execution-ready — Integrates with product, delivery, and team workflows
* Deployment-focused — Gets your capability downrange in months, not years
* 90-Day Advisory Sprint to align your team and accelerate execution with focused, embedded support
* Ongoing Partnership that stays in lockstep with your mission as you grow

Whether you're an early-stage founder facing the valley of death or a seasoned CTO trying to align product with pipeline, I help you shift from reactive scramble to deliberate success.

If you’re ready to move on from the chaos, build a culture of success, and lead with clarity—schedule a call.

Let’s get your tech where it belongs: in the hands of the warfighter.

Experience

Warfighter Ready
Founder
June 2024 - Present (1 year 2 months)
Seattle, Washington, United States

We help dual-use defense tech founders get their mission-changing capability downrange in months, not years, without getting stuck in bureaucracy, even if they’re brand new or already feeling stuck in the 'bureaucracy swamp.'

Our team focuses exclusively on dual-use startup leaders (CEOs, CTOs, and CPOs) who are building extraordinary technology but struggling to deliver it where it matters: into the hands of warfighters.

Through a combination of fractional work, structured curriculum, advising, and coaching, our clients build capability inside their companies, not just connections outside of them. The companies we support work with succeed by:

* Supporting organizations with fractional Product and Strategy positions
* Designing mission-aligned product strategies that transform prototypes into fielded capabilities
* Translating roadmaps into executable delivery plans
* Navigating the defense acquisition maze with clarity
* Building internal alignment between product, engineering, and BD
* Avoiding the traps of ‘BD Theater’ and 'Proposal Purgatory'

Our flagship offer is a 6-week execution bootcamp, followed by a 90-day implementation sprint focused on results, not theory.

Texavie

Advisor

January 2024 - Present (1 year 7 months)

I advise Texavie’s leadership team on product development and go-to-market strategy for its dual-use smart textile platform, NEAT SolarTex, a flexible solar fabric that converts ambient light into renewable energy.

My focus includes:

* Identifying Department of Defense and commercial applications to shape dual-use positioning

* Advising on product development priorities aligned with dual-use military operational and outdoor recreational use cases

* Defining early dual-use customer segments and developing targeted messaging across federal and outdoor markets

* Coaching the founding team on BD tactics that build government trust while preserving startup agility

This advisory role deepened my exposure to the dual-use ecosystem beyond software while reinforcing a key insight: innovative technology alone isn’t enough. Without the right strategy, roadmap, resources, and execution discipline, mission-changing products may never reach the field.

Probable

Founder

June 2024 - Present (1 year 2 months)

Seattle, Washington, United States

Built a dual-use AI platform designed to align teams around strategic priorities while bridging the gap between daily execution and high-level intent. Probable integrated with tools like Linear, Jira, and Notion to give leaders real-time insight into how high-level strategy and quarterly objectives mapped to daily activity, accelerating impact across both commercial and national security missions.

Hunted Labs

Head of Product

January 2025 - June 2025 (6 months)

Seattle

Drove dual-use Entercept cybersecurity product from concept to launch, aligning product development with customer pain, market research to differentiated outcomes, and company vision to business outcomes.

As Head of Product, I:

* Led the Entercept product to general availability (GA), coordinating engineering, design, and GTM functions to a successful launch and initial customer adoption.

* Conducted deep customer discovery interviews to identify pain points and opportunities of unmet value in software supply chain security

* Defined the company’s core user personas, including demographic, behavioral, and psychographic profiles, to guide feature prioritization and GTM positioning

* Ran competitive market research to isolate and emphasize differentiators in copy, roadmap, and pricing

* Completely redesigned UI and built high-fidelity prototypes to iteratively test assumptions with early users

* Wrote launch copy for the website, outbound sales campaigns, and onboarding user guides

* Established the Now / Next / Later product roadmap to connect near-term company OKRs with long-term company vision.

This work sharpened my conviction that most product failures in defense and enterprise tech come not from bad ideas, but from misalignment between product strategy, cross-functional execution, and high-velocity user outcomes.

Seeing these practices empower the successful release of Entercept necessitated the launch of our full-time consulting practice, where we now help dual-use defense tech founders and product leaders get their capability downrange in months, not years.

Rebellion Defense

3 years 2 months

GM Product Management | Iris

January 2023 - June 2024 (1 year 6 months)

Seattle, Washington, United States

Owned the product lifecycle and delivery of a $5M+ AI-enabled strategic planning portfolio for the U.S. Department of Defense, leading zero-to-one development of mission orchestration software in high-security, cloud, and disconnected environments.

Key accomplishments:

* Brought mission orchestration software from concept to revenue, generating $1M in 8 months

* Led product discovery and customer engagement to define user “Battle Manager” workflows and pain points

* Developed product vision, GTM strategy, and Now / Next / Later roadmap aligned to mission outcomes

* Built and tested a proprietary LLM to generate task interpretations, validate mission logic, and recommend adjustments—reducing tact time by 93% and improving planning throughput by 100x

* Deployed across multiple channels (cloud, on-prem, disconnected) using Docker, Kubernetes, and secure CI/CD pipelines

* Shipped advanced features including Trajectory Prediction, Pattern of Life, and Automated Target Recognition

This work exposed the most common patterns that hold back defense innovation: product/engineering misalignment, late-stage execution panic, and strategy that’s disconnected from user reality.

That experience solving these challenges has become the foundation for my consulting practice, where I now focus on helping founders lead with clarity, deploy faster, and avoid the challenges I witnessed firsthand.

Senior Technical Product Manager
May 2021 - December 2022 (1 year 8 months)
Seattle, Washington, United States

Led development and delivery of a $30M AI fusion and tracking software suite across multi-domain UAV platforms.
* Defined technical roadmap and external partner strategy to meet and exceed contract commitments

* Managed delivery of platform-agnostic SW solutions across air, land, and maritime systems

* Balanced internal R&D and customer delivery milestones to fund sustainable growth

* Led customer success efforts and transformed user feedback into roadmap insights

This role deepened my experience navigating dual-use product delivery within mission-critical environments and sharpened my perspective on aligning technical execution with strategic outcomes - Experince critical to my clients today.

Pavilion
Leadership Co-Chair; Member Seattle Division
August 2020 - January 2024 (3 years 6 months)
Seattle, Washington, United States

Co-Chair of Leadership Pillar; Member of Seattle Division.

Boeing

3 years 11 months

Senior Program Manager: Air Force One

November 2019 - May 2021 (1 year 7 months)

San Antonio, Texas Metropolitan Area

Led the successful transition of the Air Force One program from design in Seattle to build, test, and delivery in San Antonio. Responsible for coordinating cross-functional teams, classified infrastructure, and a 1,000-person workforce in one of the most visible defense programs in the world.

Key initiatives and outcomes:

* Served as a key liaison between Boeing leadership and U.S. Government stakeholders to ensure consistent progress, transparency, and mission assurance

* Designed and executed a $1.7M hiring and retention incentive strategy, enabling the relocation and onboarding of 300+ skilled employees with zero schedule slippage

* Managed $32M in facility upgrades to meet engineering, manufacturing, and security requirements—including SCIF compliance and sensitive material handling

* Oversaw Top Secret clearance process for 600+ employees, reducing average processing time by up to 69% through operational redesign and close collaboration with federal agencies

* Created an integrated program playbook to align union and non-represented workforce operations across engineering, HR, supply chain, and manufacturing

* Integrated complex contract requirements and aligned operations with FAR/DFARS to ensure compliance across acquisition, hiring, and security processes

This experience sharpened my ability to lead high-risk, complex programs where national security, technical delivery, and human systems all intersect. It also reinforced a truth I carry into my practice: operational clarity and leadership discipline are just as important as innovation when delivering federal defense capability.

Commercial Strategy Propulsion & Structures Portfolio Leader
July 2017 - November 2019 (2 years 5 months)
Seattle

Owned a $1.2B global aftermarket P&L for Boeing's Propulsion and Structures product portfolio, driving double-digit revenue and margin growth through strategic pricing, market development, and supply chain innovation.

Key achievements:
* Developed growth strategy and monetization roadmap for 50-person cross-functional team, driving $199M (+22%) revenue and $101M (+16%) earnings YoY

* Closed $285M in direct engine product sales by equipping frontline teams with data-informed GTM positioning narratives

* Spearheaded and negotiated a $250M exclusive distribution agreement, increasing margin by $69M and revenue by 9x for controls and switches category segment

* Launched a $9M internal R&D initiative to vertically integrate aftermarket supply, unlocking $115M in revenue

* Delivered executive-level pricing and bundling strategies based on competitive benchmarking and customer segmentation, resulting in record YoY growth

This role honed my ability to align market insight, internal operations, and strategic storytelling into real commercial results. I now bring these skills to founders navigating GTM uncertainty and delivery challenges in dual-use markets.

Boeing
8 years 9 months

Commercial Strategy | Systems Product Line Manager
April 2015 - May 2017 (2 years 2 months)

Owned a $500M aftermarket systems parts portfolio, leading strategy, pricing, and cross-functional initiatives to grow revenue and capture value.
* Led team of business and strategy analysts to uncover insights using regression, trend analysis, and predictive modeling

* Defined portfolio strategy and investment priorities to capitalize on emerging customer and fleet trends

* Program managed cross-functional initiatives that reduced COGS, improved availability, and unlocked untapped margin

* Balanced cost, lead time, and customer value to shape roadmap decisions and competitive positioning

This role honed my ability to manage complex P&Ls, lead analytical teams, and drive execution. I now bring these skills to my clients, building dual-use businesses with mission and margin in mind.

Lead Product Manager | Passenger Seating Systems
June 2011 - April 2015 (3 years 11 months)

Led engineering design, certification, and delivery for 787 Business and Economy Class seat systems—integrating design, production, and installation schedules to support global airline customers and critical program milestones.

Key contributions:
* Defined and enforced FAA and Boeing compliance standards for third-party seat suppliers, enhancing regulatory performance and consistency

* Managed a team of 12 engineers across design, risk, certification, and airplane-level integration for multiple seat programs

* Owned end-to-end delivery of complex, SWAP-constrained seat systems—including structural hardware and in-cabin software integrations

* Developed technical data review best practices adopted across multiple suppliers, improving drawing quality and reducing design cycle time by 40%

* Delivered hardware for Business and Economy Class programs with 100% on-time delivery and no rework penalties

* Integrated supplier readiness reviews, shipping schedules, and airplane build timelines to ensure seamless final delivery

This role embedded a deep respect for design quality, stakeholder coordination, and systems thinking under constraints. These core principles now underpin my execution frameworks for my clients.

Lead Fight Test Valuestream Product Manager
September 2008 - June 2011 (2 years 10 months)

Led resolution of design and installation conflicts on the 787 flight test program's critical path, managing cross-functional responses to test failures, certification blockers, and urgent operational disruptions. Known for turning complexity into action under pressure.

Key accomplishments:
* Orchestrated recovery effort for 787 AOG (Airplane on Ground) emergency in Laredo, TX to lead on-site planning, structural repair, and logistics coordination across Engineering, Manufacturing, and Supply Chain teams

* Developed and implemented Boeing's "Return to Flight Test Readiness" integrated plan to align engineering, tooling, planning, and part delivery schedules to reduce ground time and restore test operations

* Served as the Valuestream Product Manager for Flight Test installation, resolving interface issues between test equipment, aircraft systems, and evolving certification requirements

* Communicated critical path updates and mitigation strategies directly to Boeing executive leadership, enhancing transparency and decision velocity across functions

This experience forged my bias toward decisive communication, systems for clarity, and mission-aligned execution. These values remain central to my approach today.

Washington State Department of Transportation
Civil Engineer
July 2006 - September 2007 (1 year 3 months)

US Forest Service
Hydrologist Technician
July 2005 - September 2006 (1 year 3 months)

Education

University of Washington

Bachelor of Science (BS), Mechanical Engineering · (2004 - 2008)

Indiana University - Kelley School of Business

Master of Business Administration - MBA, Business Administration and Management, General · (2017 - 2019)

Indiana University - Kelley School of Business

Master of Science - MS, Business Analytics · (2017 - 2019)

Stevens Institute of Technology

Masters Certificate, Project Management · (2011 - 2012)